

Nails Across a Lifetime

Children, pregnancy, ageing nails, and the extra care a diabetic client's feet and hands deserve

Learning Objectives

- Adapt nail services appropriately for children
- Explain nail changes common during pregnancy and adjust service accordingly
- Explain how nail growth and structure change with age
- Apply the specific extra caution a diabetic client's nail service requires

The same service, adjusted for the person in the chair

A technically correct manicure can still be the wrong manicure for the specific person receiving it. This module asks you to hold the technique from Modules Six, Nine, and Eleven, and adjust it deliberately for four life stages and conditions that change what "correct" actually means.

Children

Favour gentle, minimal-intervention service: light filing, cuticle oil rather than any cutting, and water-based, more easily removable polish formulas where possible. This is often a child's first introduction to nail care, and a positive, unhurried, ungimmicky experience shapes years of comfort with future services.

Pregnancy

Rising hormone levels and increased circulation during pregnancy often accelerate nail growth, though nails can simultaneously become more brittle or prone to splitting for some clients. Beyond the physical changes, be mindful of strong chemical odours (acetone, primers) in a poorly ventilated space, and ensure a well-ventilated station for any pregnant

client, extending the same courtesy taught in Course III, Module Eight, for skincare and makeup services.

Ageing nails

As with hair and skin, nail growth slows with age, and nails commonly become thinner, more brittle, and more prone to the vertical ridging discussed in Module Two. Favour gentler filing, additional cuticle oil, and realistic expectations around how long polish or extensions will comfortably last on more fragile, slower-growing nails.

Diabetic clients: a specific, serious caution

Diabetes can impair circulation and slow healing, particularly in the extremities — meaning a small nick or cut that would heal quickly on most clients can become a genuinely serious wound for a diabetic client, occasionally leading to severe infection if unnoticed or poorly managed. For any client who discloses diabetes:

- Never cut the cuticle — push only, with extra gentleness, per Module Six's already-conservative standard.
- Inspect feet and hands closely for any cuts, sores, or colour changes before beginning, and decline to proceed with any invasive technique if anything of concern is present.
- Use extra caution and lighter pressure with any filing or callus removal, particularly on the feet.
- Refer any sore, wound, or significant callus concern to a podiatrist rather than treating it cosmetically — diabetic foot complications are a genuinely serious medical matter, not an area for a practitioner to manage independently.

Key Terms

0

[object Object]

1

[object Object]

Practical Activity · The Adaptation Script

Write a short consultation note describing how you would adapt a standard manicure for a seven-year-old client, and a separate note for a client who discloses diabetes during intake. Be specific about what you would change and what you would decline to do.